



FULL-DAY EMERGENCY SUB PLANS

VOLUME 2



THREE WHOLE DAYS



Complete elementary sub plans for grades 1 and 2.
Built around a read-aloud, for children who cannot yet work alone.



- ✓ Three complete school days, arrival to dismissal
- ✓ A read-aloud story for every day, printed in full
- ✓ Word work, writing, math and science every day
- ✓ Short blocks and built-in movement breaks
- ✓ Handwriting lines, drawing space and answer keys



ll



DIGITAL VECTOR

Grades 1-2 • 62 pages • digitalvector.com.au



START HERE

Most sub plans hand a substitute a worksheet. In grades 1 and 2 that fails within ten minutes, because the children cannot read the instructions and cannot work alone for long enough.

This is Volume 2. All three days are new. Like Volume 1 it is built the way the day actually runs at this age: a read-aloud on the carpet, short blocks, a movement break between most of them, and student pages with very few words on them.

What is different about a grades 1 to 2 pack

WHY IT MATTERS	
The story is read to them	The full text is printed for the substitute, with marked places to stop and ask a question. Children this age get their comprehension through listening, not reading.
Blocks are short	Roughly twenty to thirty minutes, because that is genuinely as long as a six or seven year old concentrates. There is a movement break between most of them.
The substitute talks constantly	The script pages are longer than the pages the children get. That is the correct way round for this age.
Student pages have almost no text	Numbered instruction strips, big type, drawing boxes, and handwriting lines with a dashed midline.
Math is concrete	Ten frames, number lines and real shapes, not bare number sentences.

SIXTEEN PAGES PER DAY. ELEVEN TO COPY, FIVE TO KEEP.

Copy each day as one stapled packet. Hand it out in the morning and the children work through it in order. Handing out separate sheets all day is where an unfamiliar class comes apart.

The substitute keeps the Day at a Glance page, the carpet script, the read-aloud story, and the two answer keys.

Will a substitute cope with this?

That is the question this pack is built to answer. Every block the substitute leads has the words to say printed out. The read-aloud has the whole story and the questions. The math teaching page tells them what to say out loud and what to do when a child is stuck. There is a page on holding a class you have never met, and a bank of things to do when a gap opens up.

None of it assumes any early-years training, and none of it assumes they have met your class before.





FOR THE SUBSTITUTE

If you have five minutes before the children arrive, read this page and nothing else.

IN THE FIRST FIVE MINUTES

1. Find the Day at a Glance page. Put it on the desk and leave it there.
2. Check the packets are copied. If not, copy the Morning Work page first and the rest while they work.
3. Write your name on the board.
4. Read the carpet script. Do not improvise the first minute.
5. Skim the read-aloud story so you are not seeing it for the first time in front of them.

The shape of every day in this pack

ROUGHLY	WHAT HAPPENS
Arrival	Morning work at desks. Tracing and counting. You take attendance while they work.
Carpet	Ten minutes. Introduce yourself, teach your quiet signal, say what happens before recess.
Read aloud	Fifteen minutes on the carpet, then drawing and one sentence at desks.
Morning blocks	Word work, then writing, then math. A movement break between each.
Afternoon	Quiet time with books, then the science block read aloud together.
Last ten minutes	The How Was Today? sheet, then pack up.

THREE THINGS THAT MATTER MORE THAN THE LESSONS

Say what is next before every change. "When I count to five we are putting pencils down." Children this age are not being difficult at transitions. They do not know what is coming.

Ask them to show you the routines. Where they line up, how they hand things in, who sits where. They know, they love telling you, and it makes them your allies.

Praise out loud, correct quietly. Naming a child who is doing the right thing moves a whole room. Naming one who is not hands them an audience.





The Three Days

THE THREE DAYS

Each day is completely independent. Leave them in any order. No day assumes anything from another.

DAY	STORY	WORD WORK	WRITING	MATH
4	The Shell That Talked	oo as in moon	Writing about a sound	Taking away
5	The Dog Who Would Not Come	ai and ay	Writing about help	O'clock and half past
6	The Loudest Chicken	-ight and -ink	Writing about a problem	Tally charts

The read-aloud stories

DAY	THE STORY	WHAT IT IS REALLY ABOUT
4	The Shell That Talked	A girl hears the sea in a shell, then finds out what she is really hearing, and keeps the shell anyway. Leads into sound and hearing.
5	The Dog Who Would Not Come	A dog ignores every recall, until somebody points out that coming back always ends the fun. Leads into pushes and pulls.
6	The Loudest Chicken	A hen nobody can quieten, and a neighbor problem solved with eggs instead of silence. Leads into living, once living and never alive.

WHICH DAY SHOULD I LEAVE?

A class you do not know at all: Day 4. The story is the gentlest and the math is the most concrete.

You want work you can look at when you return: Day 6. The tally chart shows you instantly who can count in fives.

A restless group, or a Friday: Day 5. The body clock game gets them up and moving with a purpose.

A NOTE ON THE READ-ALOUD

The full text of each story is printed on the substitute's page, with three marked places to stop and ask a question. Children this age get their comprehension through listening, so the story is the biggest teaching block of the morning, not a warm-up.

Read it slowly. Take two or three answers at each stop and then carry on, however many hands are still up.



Class Information



TEACHER • FILL THIS IN ONCE AT THE START OF THE YEAR

Complete this once and it works for every absence after. In an infant classroom the substitute needs far more of this than in an older grade.

THE BASICS

My name and grade _____

Room number _____

Teach this day _____ Day _____ or any day from the index

Teacher next door _____

Office extension _____

Teaching assistant _____

THE DAY

Bell times _____

Recess and lunch _____

Specials today _____

Bathroom routine

Do they go alone or in pairs? _____

Where the class lines up _____

Carpet spots

Assigned or free? _____

Fire drill point _____

THE CHILDREN

Collected by an adult?

Who, and any custody notes _____

Medical, allergies, medication _____

Accommodations _____

Children who find change hard

The most useful line on this page _____

Children who can help you _____





Holding a Class You Do Not Know

SUBSTITUTE · KEEP THIS PAGE

SIX AND SEVEN YEAR OLDS ARE NOT TESTING YOU ON PURPOSE

They are checking what the rules are with a new adult, which is a sensible thing for a small person to do. Being warm and completely predictable settles a room faster than being strict.

Say this instead of that

INSTEAD OF	TRY
"Be quiet!"	"Show me listening ears." Then wait. Do not repeat it.
"Sit down."	"Bottoms on the carpet, hands in your lap, eyes on me." Say all three parts.
"Who did that?"	"I am waiting for one more person." Never name a child in front of the class.
"Stop it."	"That is not a safe choice. Show me a safe choice." Then praise whoever does.
"Hurry up."	"I am counting to ten and then we are going." Then count. Out loud. Slowly.
"You should know this."	"Let me show you again." They might genuinely not know, and being told off for it stops them asking next time.

Five moves that work in any infant room

- **Teach a clap-back signal in the first ten minutes.** You clap a rhythm, they clap it back. Practice it once while everyone is calm.
- **Count down instead of asking twice.** "Pencils down in five, four, three..." moves a room faster than any instruction repeated.
- **Narrate what is going right.** "Table two is ready." The rest copy within seconds and nobody has been told off.
- **Give the busiest child a job.** Handing out packets, holding the door, being line leader. Redirection, not reward.
- **Get them up every twenty minutes.** Fidgeting is not misbehaviour at this age, it is a signal. The Brain Breaks page is at the back.

WHEN SOMETHING GOES PROPERLY WRONG

If a child is hurt, distressed, or a situation is beyond a normal classroom problem, send two children to the office or the teacher next door. Do not leave the class, and do not try to handle it alone because you want to seem capable.

Crying is common at this age and usually passes. Kneel down to their height, say what happens next, and give it two minutes before deciding it is serious.





EVERY PAGE IN THIS PACK

Eleven pages per day are copied for children. Five are kept by the substitute, because at this age the adult needs more paper than the class does.

PAGE	WHAT IT IS	CONTENTS
1-7	Getting started	Cover, how the pack works, substitute quick start, the three days, class information, holding a class you do not know, this page
8-9	Day 4 scripts	Day at a Glance and the carpet script. <i>Substitute keeps these.</i>
11	Day 4 read-aloud	The full story with marked places to stop and ask. <i>Substitute keeps this.</i>
10-21	Day 4 student pages	Morning work, after the story, oo as in moon, writing, taking away, how you hear, and How Was Today? Eleven pages to copy.
22-23	Day 4 answer keys	Every answer with marking notes. <i>Substitute keeps these.</i>
24-25	Day 5 scripts	Day at a Glance and the carpet script. <i>Substitute keeps these.</i>
27	Day 5 read-aloud	The full story with marked places to stop and ask. <i>Substitute keeps this.</i>
26-37	Day 5 student pages	Morning work, after the story, ai and ay, writing, o'clock and half past, pushes and pulls, and How Was Today? Eleven pages to copy.
38-39	Day 5 answer keys	Every answer with marking notes. <i>Substitute keeps these.</i>
40-41	Day 6 scripts	Day at a Glance and the carpet script. <i>Substitute keeps these.</i>
43	Day 6 read-aloud	The full story with marked places to stop and ask. <i>Substitute keeps this.</i>
42-53	Day 6 student pages	Morning work, after the story, -ight and -ink, writing, tally charts, living or never alive, and How Was Today? Eleven pages to copy.
54-55	Day 6 answer keys	Every answer with marking notes. <i>Substitute keeps these.</i>
56-60	The filler banks	Time fillers, brain breaks, wet-weather games, a fast finisher menu, and the substitute's note back
61-62	Reference	Standards alignment, terms of use and credits

THE FASTEST WAY TO USE THIS PACK

Photocopy the eleven student pages for one day as a single stapled packet. Put the five substitute pages on the desk in order. That is the whole preparation.





Day 4 at a Glance

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE ON YOUR DESK

THE WHOLE DAY, IN ONE TABLE

Times are a guide. Your school's bells win. The **Page** column tells you which sheet the children need in front of them.

Blocks are short on purpose. Children this age concentrate for about as many minutes as their age. Every block here is under thirty, and there is a movement break between most of them.

TIME	BLOCK	WHAT HAPPENS	PAGE
8:30	Arrival	Children come in and start Morning Work. Take attendance while they work.	p. 10
8:45	Carpet time	Read the script on the next page. Teach your quiet signal now.	keep
9:00	Read aloud	Read the story on the carpet. Stop at the orange boxes.	keep
9:20	After the story	Children draw and finish a sentence.	p. 12
9:40	Movement break	Two minutes. Use the Brain Breaks page.	back
9:45	Word work	Today's sound. Circle, then write.	p. 13
10:10	Recess	Ask a child where the class lines up.	—
10:30	Writing	Say it first, then write. Two pages.	p. 14-15
11:05	Math	Teaching page together, then practice.	p. 16-17
11:40	Math game	Partners. Ten minutes.	p. 18
12:00	Lunch	Line them up three minutes early.	—
12:50	Quiet time	Children look at books at their desks.	—
1:10	Afternoon	Read the science page aloud together, then the task.	p. 19-20
1:50	Specials or filler	If there is no special, use the Time Filler Bank.	back
2:30	Closing	How Was Today? sheet, then pack up.	p. 21
2:50	Dismissal	Stack all work on the desk with the closing sheets on top.	—

IF YOU ARE RUNNING BEHIND

Cut the math game and quiet time first. Never cut the movement break or the closing sheet.

THE SINGLE MOST USEFUL THING YOU CAN DO

Say what is happening next, out loud, before every change. "When I count to five we are putting pencils down and coming to the carpet." Children this age are not being difficult at transitions. They genuinely do not know what is coming.





Carpet Time and First Moves

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

THE FIRST FIFTEEN MINUTES DECIDE THE DAY

You are a stranger and they will check what the rules are with you. Being warm and completely predictable is worth more than being strict.

On the carpet, ten minutes

SAY THIS TO START

Good morning everyone. My name is on the board. Your teacher is away today and she left me a plan for the whole day, so I know exactly what we are doing. First, my quiet signal. I clap like this and you clap it back. Let us practice. Lovely. This morning we have a story about a shell, some writing, and some taking away. This afternoon we find out how your ears actually work. You will have to help me with your names.

Then, in this order

WHAT YOU DO	
1	Write your name on the board. Point at it and say it.
2	Teach the clap-back signal and practice it twice now, while everyone is calm.
3	Read the script above. Do not improvise the first minute.
4	Ask: <i>what does this class always do at carpet time?</i> Take two answers only.
5	Say what happens before recess, in order, on your fingers.
6	Start the read-aloud while they are still settled.

Four things that work with this age

INSTEAD OF	TRY
"Be quiet!"	"Show me listening ears." Then wait. Do not repeat it.
"Sit down."	"Bottoms on the carpet, hands in your lap, eyes on me." Say all three.
"Who did that?"	"I am waiting for one more person." Never name a child in front of the class.
"Stop it."	"That is not a safe choice. Show me a safe choice." Then praise the child who does.

YOUR QUIET SIGNAL

Teach one in the first ten minutes and use it all day. A clap-back pattern works everywhere: you clap a short rhythm, they clap it back. Practice it once while everyone is calm and it will work when they are not.





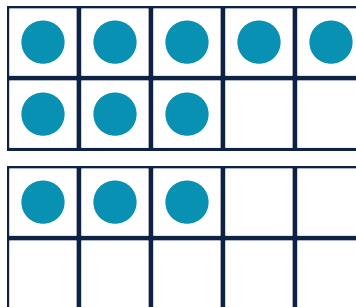
- 1 Write your name at the top.
- 2 Trace the words. Say each one out loud.
- 3 Count and write the number.
- 4 Color the picture if you finish.

1. Trace and say

moon pool look

2. Count

How many counters? Write the number in the box.



DRAW

Draw something you would like to listen to.



COLOR ME

Color Ada's shell. Then draw some waves.





Read Aloud: The Shell That Talked

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD. KEEP THIS PAGE.

HOW TO READ IT

Children sit on the carpet. Read slowly. The **orange boxes** are places to stop and ask the question printed in them. Take two or three answers, then carry on. Do not stop anywhere else, however many hands go up.

The Shell That Talked

Read-aloud story

Ada found the shell on the beach, half buried, with the sand still wet around it. It was as big as her two hands together and it was pink inside like the middle of a peach.

Her grandpa said, "Hold it up to your ear."

Ada held it up.

STOP AND ASK

What do you think she heard?

"I can hear the sea!" said Ada. "The whole sea is in there!"

"It does sound like it," said Grandpa.

They took the shell home on the bus, and Ada held it the whole way, checking every few minutes that the sea was still inside.

At home she carried it into the airing cupboard, which was the quietest place in the house, shut the door, and held it up.

The sea was still there.

STOP AND ASK

How can the sea be in the cupboard too?

"Grandpa," said Ada at tea time, "how did the sea get in?"

Grandpa put down his cup. "Try this," he said. And he cupped his own hand over her ear.

Ada went very still.

"The sea is in your hand as well," she said.

"It is in every hand," said Grandpa. "And every cup, and every bucket. It is not the sea, Ada. It is all the little sounds in this room, going round and round inside the shell until they sound big."

Ada thought about this for a long time. Then she said, "I am going to tell everybody at school."

And she did. But she still kept the shell by her bed, because knowing how it worked did not make it any less good.

STOP AND ASK

Why do you think Ada still liked the shell afterwards?





1 Draw the part you liked best.

2 Finish the sentence underneath.

DRAW YOUR FAVORITE PART



Finish this sentence

The best sound in the world is

TALK ABOUT IT

Turn to the person next to you. Close your eyes for ten seconds. Then tell them every sound you could hear.





- 1 Say each word out loud.
- 2 Circle the ones with the sound at the top.
- 3 Write two of your own on the lines.

TODAY'S SOUND

oo

Two letters, one sound. Say each word and listen in the middle.

Circle the words with the sound

moon

man

pool

book

bed

food

look

lock

room

Now write two of your own

FAST FINISHER

The **oo** in *moon* and the **oo** in *book* are not quite the same sound. Say them both. Sort your six words into two lists.





Writing: Say It First

1 Look at the words you can use.

2 Say your sentence out loud first.

3 Then write it on the lines.

TODAY YOU ARE WRITING

Write about a sound. It can be a sound you love or a sound you cannot stand. Say what it is and how it makes you feel.

Words you might need

sound

loud

quiet

listen

because

hate

love

when

A sentence to start you off

My favorite sound is





- 1 Draw your picture first.
- 2 Then write two or three sentences about it.
- 3 Check you used a capital letter and a full stop.

YOUR PICTURE

**BEFORE YOU HAND IT IN**

Point at your capital letter. Point at your full stop. Read your sentence out loud to someone at your table.



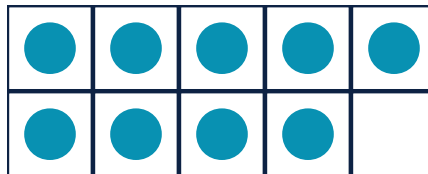


Math: Taking Away

SUBSTITUTE: READ THIS PART OUT LOUD

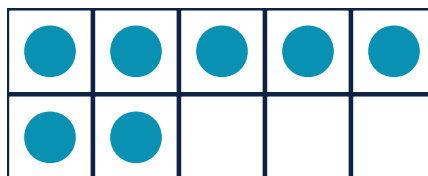
Yesterday we made ten. Today we are taking away. When you take away, the number gets smaller. You can always check with your fingers or with the counters on the page.

Taking Away



Start with 9. Cross out 4.

$$9 - 4 = 5$$



Start with 7. Cross out 2.

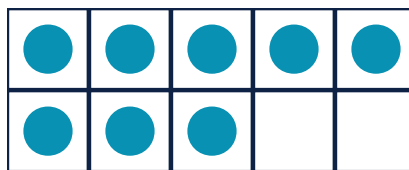
$$7 - 2 = 5$$

Both answers are 5, even though the starting numbers were different. There is more than one way to reach a number.

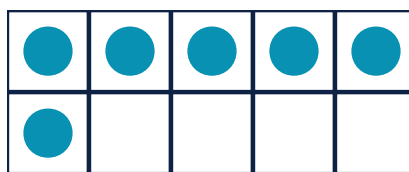
IF A CHILD IS STUCK

Give them their fingers. Hold up the first number, put down the second number, count what is left. It works every time.

Try these two together



$$8 - 3 = \underline{\quad}$$



$$6 - 5 = \underline{\quad}$$





- 1 Do them in order.
- 2 Use the pictures to help you.
- 3 Check your answers by counting again.

Take away. Cross out on the number line to help.

$$9 - 2 = __$$

$$7 - 4 = __$$

$$10 - 6 = __$$

$$5 - 5 = __$$

$$8 - 1 = __$$

$$6 - 3 = __$$

Use the number line

Start at 9. Hop back 5. Where do you land?



Start at 7. Hop back 3. Where do you land?





MATH GAME

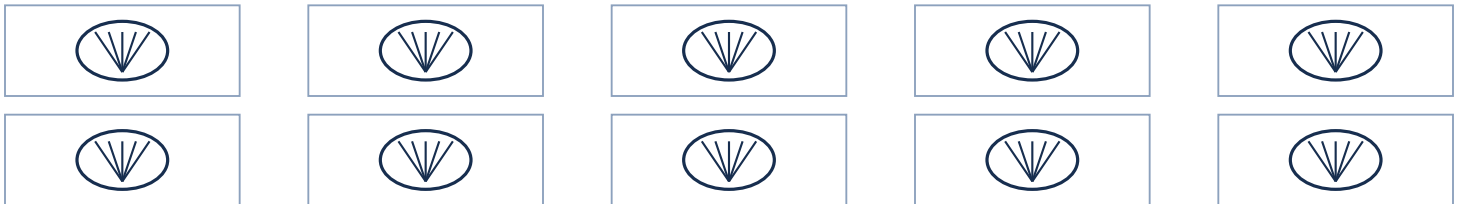
HOW TO PLAY

Play with a partner. You need this page and ten fingers each.

Shells on the Beach

1. Both players hold up any number of fingers from 1 to 10.
2. Whoever has more says the take-away sentence out loud. "I have 8, you have 3, 8 take away 3 is 5."
3. If they are right, they color one shell.
4. First to color five shells wins.

Color one shell each time you are right.



Write down three take-aways you used

FAST FINISHER

What is the biggest take-away you can make with your fingers? What is the smallest? Write both down.



**SUBSTITUTE: READ THIS OUT LOUD TOGETHER**

Read one numbered part at a time. Ask the question at the end of each before moving on.

1. Every sound starts with something shaking. A drum, a guitar string, or the bit inside your throat when you talk. Put your fingers on your throat and hum. You can feel it.

Ask: everybody hum. What can you feel?

2. The shaking pushes the air next to it. That air pushes the air next to that, all the way across the room, like a line of dominoes falling over.

Ask: does the air travel across the room, or just the pushing?

3. When it reaches you, it makes a tiny skin inside your ear shake. That is your eardrum. Your brain turns that shaking into the sound you hear.

Ask: why do you think your ear is a funny shape on the outside?

4. Ada's shell did not have the sea inside it. It caught all the tiny sounds already in the room and bounced them around inside its curl until they sounded big. Your cupped hand does the same thing.

Ask: try it. Cup your hand over your ear. What happens?





Science: How You Hear: Your Turn

- 1 Cut out the four things at the bottom.
- 2 Sort them into loud and quiet.
- 3 Draw one more of your own in either box.

LOUD SOUNDS	QUIET SOUNDS

 a drum	 a whisper	 a siren	 a cat
---	--	--	--

Write one sentence

I hear a sound when something

FAST FINISHER

Sit very still for one minute and write down every sound you can hear. How many did you find?





- 1 Color the face that shows how today felt.
- 2 Draw one thing you did today.
- 3 Write your name so your teacher knows it is yours.



Great day



Good day



Tricky day

One thing I did today

DRAW IT HERE



My name





WORD WORK

Circle: moon, pool, book, food, look, room. Not circled: man, bed, lock.

Own words: Any real word containing the sound. Invented spelling is fine at this age as long as the sound is there.

READ-ALOUD AND WRITING

Question 1: Open. Take three guesses and move on. Most children will say the sea, which sets up the whole story.

Question 2: Look for children noticing the problem: the sea cannot be in a cupboard. That confusion is exactly what the story wants. Do not resolve it yet.

Question 3: Open. Strong answers: it still sounds nice; she liked it for how it sounded, not for the sea; knowing how something works does not spoil it. That last idea is worth saying out loud if no child reaches it.

MARKING THE WRITING IN TEN SECONDS

Look for three things and nothing else: a capital letter at the start, a full stop at the end, and a sentence that makes sense when read aloud.

Do not correct spelling. At this age, invented spelling that can be sounded out is exactly what should be happening, and correcting it stops children writing.

What good looks like in grades 1 and 2

	WORKING	NOT YET
Word work	Hears the sound in a word said aloud, even if the spelling is wrong	Circles by looking at the letters only, without saying the word
Writing	One clear sentence that makes sense read aloud	A list of words with no sentence, or a copied stem
Drawing	The picture matches what they wrote	The picture and the writing are about different things
Talking	Can retell one thing that happened in the story	Retells a different story, or their own news

IF A CHILD PRODUCED NOTHING AT ALL

Do not push. Write their name on the sheet, note one line on the substitute's page at the back, and move on. A child who freezes with a stranger in the room is telling you something, and it is not about the task.





Answer Key: Math and Afternoon

MATH

	ANSWER
9 – 2	7
7 – 4	3
10 – 6	4
5 – 5	0
8 – 1	7
6 – 3	3
Try A	8 – 3 = 5
Try B	6 – 5 = 1
Number line 1	Lands on 4
Number line 2	Lands on 4

Game: Biggest is 10 take away 1, which is 9. Smallest difference is any pair that are equal, which gives 0. Both are good answers and both are worth praising.

AFTERNOON

Sort: **Loud:** a drum, a siren. **Quiet:** a whisper, a cat. Accept a well-argued cat in the loud box if the child has a loud cat.

Sentence: Look for the idea of shaking or vibrating. “Something moves” or “something shakes” are full credit. Do not correct spelling.

Part 2 question: Only the pushing travels. The air itself barely moves, like the dominoes each falling a tiny way.

Part 4 question: It gets louder, or it sounds like the sea. That is the whole story explained.

LEAVE THIS FOR THE TEACHER

Stack the day's work on the desk with the How Was Today? sheets on top. Those tell the returning teacher more in four minutes than any of the work does.





Day 5 at a Glance

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE ON YOUR DESK

THE WHOLE DAY, IN ONE TABLE

Times are a guide. Your school's bells win. The **Page** column tells you which sheet the children need in front of them.

Blocks are short on purpose. Children this age concentrate for about as many minutes as their age. Every block here is under thirty, and there is a movement break between most of them.

TIME	BLOCK	WHAT HAPPENS	PAGE
8:30	Arrival	Children come in and start Morning Work. Take attendance while they work.	p. 26
8:45	Carpet time	Read the script on the next page. Teach your quiet signal now.	keep
9:00	Read aloud	Read the story on the carpet. Stop at the orange boxes.	keep
9:20	After the story	Children draw and finish a sentence.	p. 28
9:40	Movement break	Two minutes. Use the Brain Breaks page.	back
9:45	Word work	Today's sound. Circle, then write.	p. 29
10:10	Recess	Ask a child where the class lines up.	—
10:30	Writing	Say it first, then write. Two pages.	p. 30-31
11:05	Math	Teaching page together, then practice.	p. 32-33
11:40	Math game	Partners. Ten minutes.	p. 34
12:00	Lunch	Line them up three minutes early.	—
12:50	Quiet time	Children look at books at their desks.	—
1:10	Afternoon	Read the science page aloud together, then the task.	p. 35-36
1:50	Specials or filler	If there is no special, use the Time Filler Bank.	back
2:30	Closing	How Was Today? sheet, then pack up.	p. 37
2:50	Dismissal	Stack all work on the desk with the closing sheets on top.	—

IF YOU ARE RUNNING BEHIND

Cut the math game and quiet time first. The clock work always takes longer than you expect, so protect it.

THE SINGLE MOST USEFUL THING YOU CAN DO

Say what is happening next, out loud, before every change. "When I count to five we are putting pencils down and coming to the carpet." Children this age are not being difficult at transitions. They genuinely do not know what is coming.





Carpet Time and First Moves

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

THE FIRST FIFTEEN MINUTES DECIDE THE DAY

You are a stranger and they will check what the rules are with you. Being warm and completely predictable is worth more than being strict.

On the carpet, ten minutes

SAY THIS TO START

Good morning everyone. My name is on the board. Your teacher is away today and left me a plan for the whole day. First, my quiet signal. I clap like this and you clap it back. Let us practice. Good. This morning we have a story about a dog who will not do as he is told, some writing, and some clocks. This afternoon we find out about pushes and pulls. Help me with your names.

Then, in this order

WHAT YOU DO	
1	Write your name on the board. Point at it and say it.
2	Teach the clap-back signal and practice it twice now, while everyone is calm.
3	Read the script above. Do not improvise the first minute.
4	Ask: <i>what does this class always do at carpet time?</i> Take two answers only.
5	Say what happens before recess, in order, on your fingers.
6	Start the read-aloud while they are still settled.

Four things that work with this age

INSTEAD OF	TRY
"Be quiet!"	"Show me listening ears." Then wait. Do not repeat it.
"Sit down."	"Bottoms on the carpet, hands in your lap, eyes on me." Say all three.
"Who did that?"	"I am waiting for one more person." Never name a child in front of the class.
"Stop it."	"That is not a safe choice. Show me a safe choice." Then praise the child who does.

YOUR QUIET SIGNAL

Teach one in the first ten minutes and use it all day. A clap-back pattern works everywhere: you clap a short rhythm, they clap it back. Practice it once while everyone is calm and it will work when they are not.





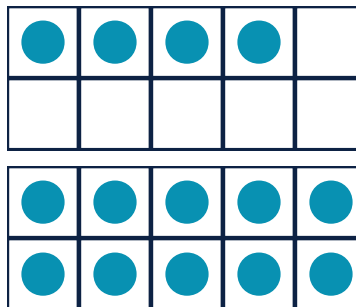
- 1 Write your name at the top.
- 2 Trace the words. Say each one out loud.
- 3 Count and write the number.
- 4 Color the picture if you finish.

1. Trace and say

rain play wait

2. Count

How many counters? Write the number in the box.



DRAW

Draw a clock face. Add the numbers and hands.



COLOR ME

Color Biscuit the dog. Then draw his lead.





Read Aloud: The Dog Who Would Not Come

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD. KEEP THIS PAGE.

HOW TO READ IT

Children sit on the carpet. Read slowly. The **orange boxes** are places to stop and ask the question printed in them. Take two or three answers, then carry on. Do not stop anywhere else, however many hands go up.

The Dog Who Would Not Come

Read-aloud story

Sam had a dog called Biscuit. Biscuit was brown and round and he was very good at nearly everything.

He could sit. He could wait. He could lie down and stay lying down even when somebody walked past with a sandwich.

But when Sam called him in the park, Biscuit did not come. Not ever. Not once.

STOP AND ASK

Why do you think Biscuit will not come?

"Biscuit!" Sam would shout. "BISCUIT! COME HERE!"

And Biscuit would look at him from all the way across the grass, and then look the other way, and carry on sniffing.

Sam got crosser and crosser. His voice got louder and louder. By the end he was almost shouting, and Biscuit was almost at the fence.

One Saturday, Sam's aunt came to the park with them. She watched for a while without saying anything.

Then she said, "Sam. What happens to Biscuit when he finally comes back?"

Sam thought. "I put his lead on," he said. "And we go home."

"And are you cross with him?"

"Yes," said Sam. "Because he never comes."

STOP AND ASK

Can you see the problem? Talk to the person next to you.

His aunt said, "So every single time he comes to you, the running stops and somebody is angry. Would you come?"

Sam did not say anything for a bit.

The next day he tried something different. He called Biscuit, and when Biscuit came he made an enormous fuss of him, gave him a bit of cheese, and then let him run off again.

He did that eleven times. Only on the twelfth did he put the lead on.

By the end of the month, Biscuit came the first time, every time.

STOP AND ASK

What did Sam change? Was it the dog or was it Sam?





1 Draw the part you liked best.

2 Finish the sentence underneath.

DRAW YOUR FAVORITE PART



Finish this sentence

I think Biscuit did not come because

TALK ABOUT IT

Turn to the person next to you. Tell them about an animal you know. What is it good at?





- 1 Say each word out loud.
- 2 Circle the ones with the sound at the top.
- 3 Write two of your own on the lines.

TODAY'S SOUND

ai and ay

Both make the same sound. Say each word and listen in the middle or at the end.

Circle the words with the sound

rain

run

play

day

dog

wait

train

trip

stay

Now write two of your own

FAST FINISHER

Look at your circled words. Which ones have **ai** in the middle and which have **ay** at the end? Is there a rule?





1 Look at the words you can use.

2 Say your sentence out loud first.

3 Then write it on the lines.

TODAY YOU ARE WRITING

Sam's aunt helped him see the problem in a kind way. Write about a time somebody helped you understand something, or a time you helped somebody else.

Words you might need

helped

showed

understand

because

tried

better

then

kind

A sentence to start you off

Somebody helped me when





- 1 Draw your picture first.
- 2 Then write two or three sentences about it.
- 3 Check you used a capital letter and a full stop.

YOUR PICTURE

**BEFORE YOU HAND IT IN**

Point at your capital letter. Point at your full stop. Read your sentence out loud to someone at your table.





Math: O'Clock and Half Past

SUBSTITUTE: READ THIS PART OUT LOUD

A clock has two hands. The short fat one tells you the hour. The long thin one tells you the minutes. Today we only need two positions: straight up, and straight down.

O'Clock and Half Past



3 o'clock



Half past 3

Long hand straight up. Short hand on the 3. Long hand straight down. Short hand halfway past the 3.

IF A CHILD IS STUCK

Point at the long hand first, every time. Straight up means o'clock, straight down means half past. Only then look at the short hand.

Try these two together



Time = _____



Time = _____





- 1 Do them in order.
- 2 Use the pictures to help you.
- 3 Check your answers by counting again.

Write the time under each clock.



Now match the time to the thing you do

TIME	WHAT MIGHT BE HAPPENING?
8 o'clock in the morning	
Half past 12	
3 o'clock in the afternoon	
Half past 7 in the evening	





MATH GAME

HOW TO PLAY

Play with a partner. You need this page and your two arms.

Body Clock

1. Player one says a time. It must be an o'clock or a half past.
2. Player two makes that time with their arms. One arm is the long hand, the other is the short hand.
3. If they get it right, they tick a box.
4. Swap. First to five ticks wins.

--	--	--	--	--

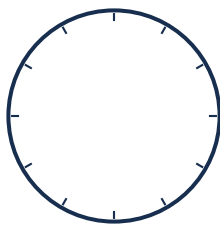
Write down three times you made

FAST FINISHER

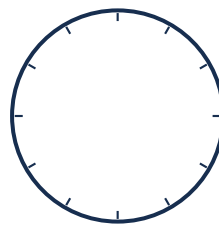
What time do you get up? What time do you go to bed? Draw both on clock faces.



Wake-up time



Bedtime



**SUBSTITUTE: READ THIS OUT LOUD TOGETHER**

Read one numbered part at a time. Ask the question at the end of each before moving on.

1. Everything that moves was pushed or pulled. There is no third option. Even a ball rolling down a hill is being pulled by the Earth.

Ask: push your hands together. Now pull them apart. Which is which?

2. When Sam held Biscuit's lead and Biscuit ran ahead, Biscuit was **pulling**. When Sam wanted to stop him, he pulled back the other way.

Ask: if they both pull equally hard, what happens?

3. A bigger push makes a thing move further and faster. A tiny push on a ball rolls it a little way. A big kick sends it across the field.

Ask: what else could you change to make the ball go further?

4. Pushes and pulls also change **direction**, not just speed. A goalkeeper does not stop the ball by making it slower. She pushes it a different way.

Ask: name three pushes and three pulls you have done today already.





Science: Pushes and Pulls: Your Turn

- 1 Look at each picture word.
- 2 Write P for push or L for pull.
- 3 Two of them are both. Find them.

WHAT YOU ARE DOING	PUSH OR PULL?	HOW DO YOU KNOW?
Opening a drawer		
Closing a door		
Kicking a ball		
Walking a dog on a lead		
Riding a swing		
DRAW YOURSELF PUSHING OR PULLING SOMETHING		
In my picture I am		

FAST FINISHER

Find three things in the room you could push and three you could pull. Write them in two lists.





- 1 Color the face that shows how today felt.
- 2 Draw one thing you did today.
- 3 Write your name so your teacher knows it is yours.



Great day



Good day



Tricky day

One thing I did today

DRAW IT HERE



My name





Answer Key: Literacy

WORD WORK

Circle: rain, play, day, wait, train, stay. Not circled: run, dog, trip.

Own words: Any real word containing the sound. Invented spelling is fine at this age as long as the sound is there.

READ-ALOUD AND WRITING

Question 1: Open. Take three guesses. Nobody will get it yet and that is fine.

Question 2: This is the important one. Look for: coming back always means the fun stops; Sam is always cross when he comes; so Biscuit learns that coming is bad. Give them time to talk before taking answers.

Question 3: Sam changed, not the dog. He made coming back a good thing instead of the end of the fun. Worth saying out loud even if a child gets there first.

MARKING THE WRITING IN TEN SECONDS

Look for three things and nothing else: a capital letter at the start, a full stop at the end, and a sentence that makes sense when read aloud.

Do not correct spelling. At this age, invented spelling that can be sounded out is exactly what should be happening, and correcting it stops children writing.

What good looks like in grades 1 and 2

	WORKING	NOT YET
Word work	Hears the sound in a word said aloud, even if the spelling is wrong	Circles by looking at the letters only, without saying the word
Writing	One clear sentence that makes sense read aloud	A list of words with no sentence, or a copied stem
Drawing	The picture matches what they wrote	The picture and the writing are about different things
Talking	Can retell one thing that happened in the story	Retells a different story, or their own news

IF A CHILD PRODUCED NOTHING AT ALL

Do not push. Write their name on the sheet, note one line on the substitute's page at the back, and move on. A child who freezes with a stranger in the room is telling you something, and it is not about the task.





Answer Key: Math and Afternoon

MATH

	ANSWER
Try A	7 o'clock
Try B	Half past 11
Clock 1	5 o'clock
Clock 2	Half past 9
Clock 3	12 o'clock
Clock 4	Half past 2
Matching	Open. Getting to school, lunch, home time and bedtime are the usual answers. Any sensible answer is correct.

Game: Open. Watch for children putting the short arm exactly on the number for half past times; it should sit halfway between. Do not make a fuss about it at this age.

AFTERNOON

Answers: Drawer = **pull** to open. Door = **push** to close. Ball = **push**. Dog on a lead = **both**, the dog pulls and you pull back. Swing = **both**, somebody pushes you and gravity pulls you back down.

Part 2 question: Nothing moves. Two equal pulls in opposite directions cancel out. Children usually work this out from tug-of-war.

Part 3 question: Make the ball lighter, make the ground smoother, or push it downhill. Any sensible answer.

LEAVE THIS FOR THE TEACHER

Stack the day's work on the desk with the How Was Today? sheets on top. Those tell the returning teacher more in four minutes than any of the work does.





Day 6 at a Glance

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE ON YOUR DESK

THE WHOLE DAY, IN ONE TABLE

Times are a guide. Your school's bells win. The **Page** column tells you which sheet the children need in front of them.

Blocks are short on purpose. Children this age concentrate for about as many minutes as their age. Every block here is under thirty, and there is a movement break between most of them.

TIME	BLOCK	WHAT HAPPENS	PAGE
8:30	Arrival	Children come in and start Morning Work. Take attendance while they work.	p. 42
8:45	Carpet time	Read the script on the next page. Teach your quiet signal now.	keep
9:00	Read aloud	Read the story on the carpet. Stop at the orange boxes.	keep
9:20	After the story	Children draw and finish a sentence.	p. 44
9:40	Movement break	Two minutes. Use the Brain Breaks page.	back
9:45	Word work	Today's sound. Circle, then write.	p. 45
10:10	Recess	Ask a child where the class lines up.	—
10:30	Writing	Say it first, then write. Two pages.	p. 46-47
11:05	Math	Teaching page together, then practice.	p. 48-49
11:40	Math game	Partners. Ten minutes.	p. 50
12:00	Lunch	Line them up three minutes early.	—
12:50	Quiet time	Children look at books at their desks.	—
1:10	Afternoon	Read the science page aloud together, then the task.	p. 51-52
1:50	Specials or filler	If there is no special, use the Time Filler Bank.	back
2:30	Closing	How Was Today? sheet, then pack up.	p. 53
2:50	Dismissal	Stack all work on the desk with the closing sheets on top.	—

IF YOU ARE RUNNING BEHIND

Cut the math game first. The tally chart is the most valuable part of the math block, so keep it if you can.

THE SINGLE MOST USEFUL THING YOU CAN DO

Say what is happening next, out loud, before every change. "When I count to five we are putting pencils down and coming to the carpet." Children this age are not being difficult at transitions. They genuinely do not know what is coming.





Carpet Time and First Moves

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

THE FIRST FIFTEEN MINUTES DECIDE THE DAY

You are a stranger and they will check what the rules are with you. Being warm and completely predictable is worth more than being strict.

On the carpet, ten minutes

SAY THIS TO START

Good morning everyone. My name is on the board. Your teacher is away today and left me a plan for the whole day. First, my quiet signal. I clap like this and you clap it back. Let us practice. Lovely. This morning we have a story about a very loud chicken, some writing, and some counting with tallies. This afternoon we sort things into living and not living, and it is harder than it sounds. Help me with your names.

Then, in this order

WHAT YOU DO	
1	Write your name on the board. Point at it and say it.
2	Teach the clap-back signal and practice it twice now, while everyone is calm.
3	Read the script above. Do not improvise the first minute.
4	Ask: <i>what does this class always do at carpet time?</i> Take two answers only.
5	Say what happens before recess, in order, on your fingers.
6	Start the read-aloud while they are still settled.

Four things that work with this age

INSTEAD OF	TRY
"Be quiet!"	"Show me listening ears." Then wait. Do not repeat it.
"Sit down."	"Bottoms on the carpet, hands in your lap, eyes on me." Say all three.
"Who did that?"	"I am waiting for one more person." Never name a child in front of the class.
"Stop it."	"That is not a safe choice. Show me a safe choice." Then praise the child who does.

YOUR QUIET SIGNAL

Teach one in the first ten minutes and use it all day. A clap-back pattern works everywhere: you clap a short rhythm, they clap it back. Practice it once while everyone is calm and it will work when they are not.





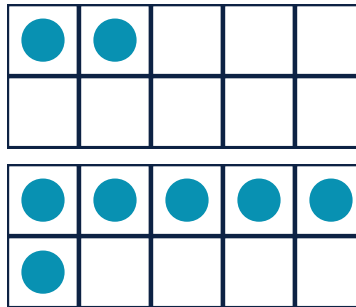
- 1 Write your name at the top.
- 2 Trace the words. Say each one out loud.
- 3 Count and write the number.
- 4 Color the picture if you finish.

1. Trace and say

night think light

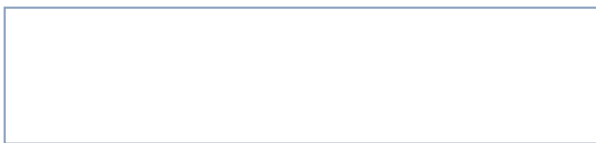
2. Count

How many counters? Write the number in the box.



DRAW

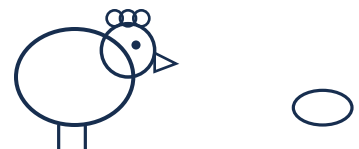
Draw your favorite animal. Write its sound below.



Sound: _____

COLOR ME

Color Doris the chicken and her egg.





Read Aloud: The Loudest Chicken

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD. KEEP THIS PAGE.

HOW TO READ IT

Children sit on the carpet. Read slowly. The **orange boxes** are places to stop and ask the question printed in them. Take two or three answers, then carry on. Do not stop anywhere else, however many hands go up.

The Loudest Chicken

Read-aloud story

There were nine chickens at the bottom of the garden and eight of them were perfectly normal.

The ninth was called Doris.

Doris was small and brown and looked exactly like all the others. But when Doris laid an egg, she announced it. Not a little cluck. An enormous, screaming, going-on-for-two-minutes announcement that could be heard three gardens away.

STOP AND ASK

How do you think the neighbors felt about Doris?

Mr. Patel next door came to the fence. He said, kindly, that he worked nights and slept in the mornings, and that Doris made sleeping quite difficult.

So Ellie tried things.

She moved the nest box to the far end of the run. Doris followed it and shouted from there instead.

She put up a windbreak. Doris shouted over it.

She tried giving Doris a snack at exactly the moment she usually laid, on the theory that a chicken with a beak full of corn cannot shout. Doris ate the corn and then shouted.

STOP AND ASK

What would you try next?

In the end Ellie did something she had not thought of. She went to Mr. Patel with a box of six eggs and said sorry.

Mr. Patel looked at the eggs for a while.

Then he said, "Every week?"

"Every week," said Ellie.

And that was the arrangement, from then on. Doris carried on shouting every single morning, and Mr. Patel carried on hearing her, and he did not mind any more, which is a different thing from her being quieter.

STOP AND ASK

Did Ellie solve the problem? Talk to the person next to you.





1 Draw the part you liked best.

2 Finish the sentence underneath.

DRAW YOUR FAVORITE PART



Finish this sentence

I think Doris shouted because

TALK ABOUT IT

Turn to the person next to you. Tell them about the loudest sound you have ever heard.





- 1 Say each word out loud.
- 2 Circle the ones with the sound at the top.
- 3 Write two of your own on the lines.

TODAY'S SOUND

-ight and -ink

Look at the end of each word. Say it out loud first.

Circle the words with the sound

night

note

think

light

lot

pink

right

rain

drink

Now write two of your own

FAST FINISHER

Write two more **-ight** words and two more **-ink** words. The **gh** in *night* is silent, which is very annoying and completely true.





Writing: Say It First

- 1 Look at the words you can use.
- 2 Say your sentence out loud first.
- 3 Then write it on the lines.

TODAY YOU ARE WRITING

Ellie could not stop Doris being loud, so she fixed it a different way. Write about a problem you could not fix, and what you did instead.

Words you might need

problem

tried

instead

because

could not

then

better

sorry

A sentence to start you off

One time I could not





- 1 Draw your picture first.
- 2 Then write two or three sentences about it.
- 3 Check you used a capital letter and a full stop.

YOUR PICTURE

**BEFORE YOU HAND IT IN**

Point at your capital letter. Point at your full stop. Read your sentence out loud to someone at your table.





Math: Counting with Tallies

SUBSTITUTE: READ THIS PART OUT LOUD

When you are counting lots of things, writing numbers is slow and you lose your place. A tally is a mark for each thing, and every fifth mark goes across the other four, so you can count them in fives.

Counting with Tallies



The fifth mark goes **across** the other four. Then you start a new group. To count, count the groups in fives and add on the leftovers.

TALLY	HOW TO COUNT IT	NUMBER
One group and three more	5, then 6, 7, 8	8
Two groups and one more	5, 10, then 11	11

IF A CHILD IS STUCK

Count the crossed groups first, in fives, pointing at each one. Then count the leftovers one at a time. Doing it in that order stops most mistakes.

Try these two together

A. Three groups of five and two more. How many?

15

17

32

B. How would you tally the number 9?

one group + 4

two groups

nine lines





- 1 Do them in order.
- 2 Use the pictures to help you.
- 3 Check your answers by counting again.

1. Ellie counted the eggs each day for a week. Fill in the numbers.

DAY	TALLY	NUMBER
Monday	One group and two more	
Tuesday	Four lines	
Wednesday	Two groups	
Thursday	One group and four more	
Friday	Two groups and three more	

2. Use your table

a. Which day had the most eggs?

b. Which day had the fewest?

c. How many more eggs on Friday than on Tuesday?





MATH GAME

HOW TO PLAY

Play with a partner. You need this page.

Tally Hunt

1. Pick something to count in the room. Chairs, windows, pencils, people wearing blue.
2. Count it using tallies in the box below. Do not use numbers.
3. Swap with your partner and check each other.

WHAT I COUNTED	MY TALLY	NUMBER

Which was the biggest number?

FAST FINISHER

Count something that is hard to count, like how many times somebody says a word in one minute.
Tally it.



**SUBSTITUTE: READ THIS OUT LOUD TOGETHER**

Read one numbered part at a time. Ask the question at the end of each before moving on.

1. Doris the chicken is **living**. Living things grow, need food and water, make more of themselves, and move in some way.

Ask: name three living things you can see right now.

2. A plant is living too, even though it does not run about. It grows, it drinks, and it makes seeds. Moving about is not on the list.

Ask: is a tree living? How do you know?

3. Some things were **once living** and are not any more. A log. A leaf on the ground. A feather. They came from something that was alive.

Ask: what about the paper you are writing on?

4. And some things were **never alive** at all. A rock. A spoon. A plastic chair. They never grew and they never needed anything.

Ask: is a car alive? It moves and it drinks fuel. Why not?





- 1 Cut out the six things at the bottom.
- 2 Sort them into the three boxes.
- 3 Two of them will start an argument. That is fine.

LIVING	ONCE LIVING
NEVER ALIVE	NOT SURE

 a chicken	 a rock	 a leaf
 a tree	 paper	 a car

A car is not alive because

FAST FINISHER

Find three things on your table. Sort them into living, once living, and never alive. Draw them in the right box.





- 1 Color the face that shows how today felt.
- 2 Draw one thing you did today.
- 3 Write your name so your teacher knows it is yours.



Great day



Good day



Tricky day

One thing I did today

DRAW IT HERE



My name





Answer Key: Literacy

WORD WORK

Circle: night, think, light, pink, right, drink. Not circled: note, lot, rain.

Own words: Any real word containing the sound. Invented spelling is fine at this age as long as the sound is there.

READ-ALOUD AND WRITING

Question 1: Open. Annoyed, tired, cross. Accept anything with a reason.

Question 2: Open. Take four ideas quickly. This is a brainstorm, not a test.

Question 3: The genuinely interesting one, and it splits a class. She did not stop the noise, so the problem is still there. But nobody minds any more, so the problem is gone. Both answers are right and a disagreement here is the best possible outcome.

MARKING THE WRITING IN TEN SECONDS

Look for three things and nothing else: a capital letter at the start, a full stop at the end, and a sentence that makes sense when read aloud.

Do not correct spelling. At this age, invented spelling that can be sounded out is exactly what should be happening, and correcting it stops children writing.

What good looks like in grades 1 and 2

	WORKING	NOT YET
Word work	Hears the sound in a word said aloud, even if the spelling is wrong	Circles by looking at the letters only, without saying the word
Writing	One clear sentence that makes sense read aloud	A list of words with no sentence, or a copied stem
Drawing	The picture matches what they wrote	The picture and the writing are about different things
Talking	Can retell one thing that happened in the story	Retells a different story, or their own news

IF A CHILD PRODUCED NOTHING AT ALL

Do not push. Write their name on the sheet, note one line on the substitute's page at the back, and move on. A child who freezes with a stranger in the room is telling you something, and it is not about the task.





Answer Key: Math and Afternoon

MATH

	ANSWER
Try A	17
Try B	one group + 4
Monday	7
Tuesday	4
Wednesday	10
Thursday	9
Friday	13
a	Friday, with 13
b	Tuesday, with 4
c	9 more

Game: Open. The skill is using tallies rather than numbers, and crossing the fifth mark. Check that, not the totals.

AFTERNOON

Sort: **Living:** a chicken, a tree. **Once living:** a leaf, paper. **Never alive:** a rock, a car.

The arguments: **Paper** and **a car** are the two that split a class. Paper comes from trees, so it was once living. A car moves and takes in fuel, but it never grew and cannot make another car, so it was never alive. Both arguments are worth having.

Part 3 question: Paper is made from wood, which came from a tree, so it was once living.

Sentence: Look for: it never grew, or it cannot make baby cars, or it was made in a factory. All full credit.

LEAVE THIS FOR THE TEACHER

Stack the day's work on the desk with the How Was Today? sheets on top. Those tell the returning teacher more in four minutes than any of the work does.





Time Filler Bank

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE. YOU WILL NEED IT.

WHY THIS PAGE EXISTS

An infant day is full of gaps: five minutes before specials, ten because lunch ran late, the wait while thirty children put their coats on. Those gaps are where a class you do not know falls apart.

Nothing below needs any equipment at all.

Under three minutes

ACTIVITY	HOW IT WORKS
Simon says	Never fails at this age. Speed it up to make it harder. You can play it in a line waiting for the bell.
Copy my clap	You clap a rhythm, they clap it back. Make it longer each time. Doubles as your quiet signal.
Head, shoulders, knees	Sing it. Then sing it faster. Then sing it missing out one body part.
Silent count to ten	The class counts to ten, one number per child, nobody chosen and no two speaking at once. Start again on a clash. Absorbing and very quiet.
I spy	Use the first sound, not the letter name. "I spy something starting with mmm." That makes it phonics.

Three to ten minutes

ACTIVITY	HOW IT WORKS
The rhyming game	You say a word. Go round the circle adding rhymes. Made-up words are allowed and make it funnier.
What is missing?	Put five things on a table. Children close their eyes. Take one away. What has gone?
Story chain	You start a story with one sentence. Each child adds one sentence around the circle. Absurd is fine.
Guess my animal	You think of an animal. They ask yes or no questions. Cap it at ten questions and count them out loud.
Number of the day	Pick a number under 20. Children say everything they know about it: one more, one less, how to make it, what it looks like on fingers.
Draw what I say	Describe a simple picture out loud. They draw it without seeing it. Compare at the end. Very funny and it teaches listening.
Freeze dance, no music	You clap a beat, they move. You stop, they freeze. Needs nothing.

TWO RULES FOR ANY OF THESE

Say how it ends before it starts, and do not offer a choice. Pick one, announce it, run it. Asking thirty six-year-olds what they would like to play turns a calm five minutes into a difficult fifteen.





Brain Breaks and Transitions

SUBSTITUTE · KEEP THIS PAGE

USE ONE EVERY TWENTY MINUTES, NOT WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Children this age concentrate for roughly as many minutes as their age, plus a little. A break every twenty minutes is not lost time. It is what buys you the next twenty.

Signs you needed one five minutes ago: chairs tipping, three bathroom requests in a row, or the same question asked twice.

At their seats, one minute

BREAK	WHAT TO DO
Ten and ten	Ten shoulder rolls back, ten forward. Everyone stays seated.
Sky and toes	Reach to the sky for five, touch your toes for five. Repeat three times.
Five big breaths	In through the nose for four, out through the mouth for six. Genuinely calms a room before writing.
Cross-body taps	Right hand to left knee, left hand to right knee, twenty times. Crossing the midline really does help them refocus.

Standing up, two to three minutes

BREAK	WHAT TO DO
Animal moves	Hop like a frog, stretch like a cat, stomp like an elephant. Ten seconds each. They will suggest more.
Four corners	Name the corners one to four. Call a number, everyone moves. Call them faster.
Popcorn	Everyone crouches. You call names, and each child pops up and back down. Speed up.
Follow the leader	You lead a march around the room and back to the carpet. Excellent for moving a class somewhere without a queue.
Shake it out	Shake one hand for eight, other hand for eight, one foot, other foot. Then four, then two, then one.

GETTING THEM BACK

Always say how it ends before it starts. "When I clap twice we are sitting down ready." A break without a stated ending is just noise you now have to fix.





SUBSTITUTE • FOR THE DAY IT RAINS

INDOOR RECESS IS THE HARDEST PART OF AN INFANT COVER DAY

They expect free time, you do not know the rules, and the room is not built for it. Pick **one** activity, announce it clearly, and run it for the whole period. Offering choices is what turns wet play into chaos.

Whole class, no equipment

GAME	HOW IT WORKS
Sleeping lions	Everyone lies still. You walk around. Anyone who moves or giggles sits up and helps you spot the others. Buys you fifteen quiet minutes and they never tire of it.
Heads down, thumbs up	Four children are chosen. Everyone else puts heads down, thumb up. The four each press one thumb. Those chosen guess who picked them.
The detective game	One child leaves. The class picks a leader who starts actions everyone copies. The detective returns and works out who is leading.
Corners	Number the corners. Call a number. Anyone in that corner sits down. Last standing wins.
Simon says tournament	Same game, but out means sitting down and helping you spot mistakes. Runs twenty minutes.

At desks, quieter

- **Draw your bedroom** from above, looking down. Harder and more absorbing than it sounds.
- **Roll and draw.** No dice? Children pick a number one to six, and you call one out. Each number is a body part to add to a monster.
- **Name that pattern.** Draw a repeating pattern on the board and children copy it and continue it.
- **Partner drawing.** One child draws a shape, the partner turns it into a picture.

TWO RULES TO STATE AT THE START

Everyone stays in the room, and when you clap the game stops instantly. Say both before you start, not after something goes wrong.





COPY THIS PAGE FOR CHILDREN

1 Pick any box.**2** You do not need to ask.**3** Use the back of your sheet.

TRY THIS

- 1 Draw your favorite animal. Label three parts of it.
- 2 Write your name using only capital letters. Then only small letters. Which was harder?
- 3 Draw a picture of the story we read today. Put yourself in it.
- 4 Find five things in the room that are round. Draw them.
- 5 Count how many chairs are in the room. Write the number. Count again to check.
- 6 Write three words that rhyme with **cat**.
- 7 Draw a machine that would tidy your bedroom for you.
- 8 Write a sentence about what you will do after school.
- 9 Draw a map of your classroom. Show the door and the carpet.
- 10 Draw something you are good at.

SPACE TO WORK

STILL FINISHED?

Look at a book quietly, or help someone at your table. Helping means asking them a question, not doing it for them.





SUBSTITUTE • FILL THIS IN BEFORE YOU LEAVE

THREE THINGS, THEN YOU ARE DONE

1. Stack the day's work on the desk with the How Was Today? sheets on top.
2. Name two or three children who genuinely helped. Teachers act on this and the children find out.
3. Write one line about anything the teacher should know. One line.

NOTE BACK TO THE TEACHER

My name

Day taught

Day 1 / Day 2 / Day 3

We got through

All of it / Most of it / The morning only

What we did not reach

Children who helped

Anyone upset or unwell

Anything else

One line is plenty

Would I come back?

Yes, gladly / Yes / Probably not, because:

A NOTE TO THE RETURNING TEACHER

The most useful thing in the pile is not the worksheets. It is the stack of How Was Today? sheets, where each child has colored a face and drawn one thing they did. Read those first. They take four minutes and they will tell you more about the day than any of the work.





COMMON CORE AND NGSS • GRADES 1-2

Each block is mapped to its primary standard. Standards are given at grade 1 and apply with light adjustment across both grades.

DAY	BLOCK	FOCUS	STANDARD
1	Read aloud	Listening comprehension, retell, prediction	RL.1.1, RL.1.2, SL.1.2
1	Word work	Long vowel team ea	RF.1.3, RF.1.2
1	Writing	Personal narrative sentence	W.1.3
1	Math	Number bonds to ten	1.OA.C.6, 1.OA.D.8
1	Science	Animals and seasonal change	1-LS1-1
2	Read aloud	Character feelings and evidence	RL.1.3, SL.1.2
2	Word work	Consonant digraphs sh, ch, th	RF.1.3
2	Writing	Writing about an experience	W.1.3
2	Math	2D shapes, sides and repeating patterns	1.G.A.1, 1.G.A.2
2	Science	Properties of materials	2-PS1-1, 2-PS1-2
3	Read aloud	Cause and effect, forming an opinion	RL.1.1, SL.1.1
3	Word work	Rhyming word families	RF.1.2, RF.1.3
3	Writing	Procedural writing with sequence words	W.1.2
3	Math	Comparing and ordering length	1.MD.A.1, 1.MD.A.2
3	Science	What plants need to grow	2-LS2-1

Also practiced every day

- Letter formation, through the tracing and handwriting lines
- Counting and number recognition, through the morning ten frames
- Speaking and listening, through the carpet discussion and turn-and-talk prompts
- Self-assessment, through the How Was Today? sheet

A NOTE ON STANDARDS

These are complete instructional days, not curriculum coverage. They are designed to be genuinely useful on a day the regular teacher is absent, without depending on where a class has reached in its own program. Every day stands alone.

This resource is independently created and is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or reviewed by any state agency or standards body.





THANK YOU

Thank you for buying this pack. It was written by a practicing teacher with more than twenty years in classrooms, and built the way I would want a full day of infant cover built if I were the one waking up sick at half past five.

If it saved you a morning, a rating on the listing genuinely helps other teachers find it, and earns you credit toward your next purchase.

Getting the most out of this pack

- **Print all three days before you need them.** The whole point is that it works on a morning when you cannot get to school to print anything.
- **Copy each day as one stapled packet.** Eleven student pages. Handing out one packet removes most of the transitions where an infant class comes apart.
- **Keep the five substitute pages in order on the desk.** Day at a Glance, carpet script, read-aloud story, two answer keys.
- **Fill in the Class Information page once,** at the start of the year.
- **Use the filler banks when you are present too.** The brain breaks and wet weather pages work on any Tuesday.

Terms of use

You may: print this pack for your own classroom, as many times as you like, for as many years as you like. Photocopy the student pages freely for your own children and leave the pack for a substitute covering your own class.

You may not: share the file with colleagues, upload it to a school drive, district server, or any public website, resell it, or claim it as your own work. Additional licenses for colleagues are available at a discount on the listing page.

All stories, tasks, questions and answer keys in this pack are original works written for this resource and are copyright of the author. No third-party copyrighted material is reproduced anywhere in this pack.

ALSO FROM DIGITAL VECTOR

Full-Day Sub Plans, Grades 3-5, Volumes 1 and 2. Six complete days for older elementary classes.

Emergency Sub Plans for Middle School Science, Math, ELA and Computer Science. Single-period lessons, grades 6 to 8.

No Lab Required. Ten paper science investigations with real data, grades 6 to 8.

Credits

Written, designed and typeset by Clarence Goh. Set in Lato and JetBrains Mono.

Digital Vector · digitalvector.com.au

© Clarence Goh / Digital Vector. All rights reserved.

